'Affies', representing the school in matches against rivals such as Grey College, Bloemfontein and Pretoria Boys' High, but the schedule became complex on the big sporting days when tennis clashed with either the rugby or the cricket.

A choice had to be made, and I decided to stop playing tennis.

Why?

I wanted to play team sports. At Affies, I saw the special spirit and camaraderie within a team, whether it was rugby or cricket. I felt the intensity of a group of people pulling together under pressure, celebrating together in victory and feeling sad together in defeat, and I loved every minute of it. For me, there was nothing more exhilarating, nothing more worthwhile than being part of a team, setting the team above everything.

Looking back, I learned a lot from tennis. I will always remember the advice given to me by Danny Sullivan and his father Oom Derek, and I eventually learned to control my nerves, to conceal my utter devastation when I lost and, ultimately, to take responsibility for my performance.

It was not an easy decision and, in some respects, I felt as though I was letting down my parents, specifically my mother who had committed so much time and effort to my tennis and who would have so much enjoyed seeing me go further in the game, maybe even to Wimbledon, but she understood my reasons. I clearly remember her telling me she agreed with my choice – and, as ever, she offered unconditional support.